



many different groups who, over thousands of years, have shared their ideas, practices, and experiences with each other. For this reason the groups share similarities. Due to their intimate

knowledge and understanding of the harsh environment and their ability to accept change, they have survived to become some of the oldest living cultures in the world.



WEAVING

The women make mats, baskets, and other containers by weaving many materials together, such as pandanus, palm fronds, bark, grasses, and even human hair. The items are colored with natural dyes made from roots or bark and are sometimes decorated with feathers or pieces of cloth. The Aborigines are famous for their arts, and woven products as well as their paintings are sold throughout Australia.

THE NGANGIYAL

This tentlike basket is called a *ngangiyal*. It is a special tent made of woven pandanus and is used for what the Aborigines refer to as “private women’s business.” As these children show it’s also fun to play with!



THE BOOMERANG

Boomerangs are curved wooden throwing sticks used as hunting weapons and as clapsticks during ceremonies. They are cleverly designed to return to you when thrown. They are made from many types of wood and are often decorated.



The two children on the left are accompanying the didgeridoo player with their clapsticks.

THE DIDGERIDOO

A musical instrument, the didgeridoo is a long, thin tree trunk, usually made from a eucalyptus tree that has been hollowed out by termites. The trunk is cut to 3 ft (1 m) or so in length and fitted with a waxy mouthpiece. When blown it makes low rumbling notes. It is very difficult to play, but experts can make it sound like the callings of certain birds and animals.

